

Class 12 Revision: Poem 2 Keeping Quiet

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (15 marks)

1. Extract 1:

Now we will count to twelve and we will all keep still.

For once on the face of the

Earth let's not speak in any language,

let's stop for one second,

and not move our arms so much.

1.1 What does the poet want us to do when he says, "let's not speak in any language"? (1 mark)

- a) Speak in sign language
- b) Speak in our mother tongue only
- c) Observe complete silence
- d) Speak in a foreign language

1.2 Choose the option that best describes the poet's tone in these lines. (1 mark)

- a) Aggressive
- b) Persuasive
- c) Humorous
- d) Ironic

1.3 Assertion: The poet urges for silence and stillness.

Reason: He believes this will help us connect with each other. (1 mark)

- a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

1.4 Assertion: The poet asks us to stop moving our arms.

Reason: He wants to avoid any physical violence. (1 mark)

- a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

1.5 Pick the word that is similar in meaning to "exotic" as used in the poem. (1 mark)

- a) Ordinary
- b) Common
- c) Familiar
- d) Unusual

2. Extract 2:

Those who prepare green wars,

wars with gas, wars with fire,

victory with no survivors,
would put on clean clothes and
walk about with their brothers in the shade,
doing nothing.

2.1 What does the phrase "green wars" refer to? (1 mark)

- a) Eco-friendly battles
- b) Wars fought in green fields
- c) Wars that destroy the environment
- d) Peaceful protests

2.2 What is the outcome of "wars with gas, wars with fire"? (1 mark)

- a) Glorious victory
- b) Defeat
- c) No survivors
- d) Peace treaty

2.3 Assertion: The poet is critical of destructive wars.

Reason: Such wars lead to immense suffering and loss. (1 mark)

- a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

2.4 Assertion: The poet imagines a world where warmongers renounce violence.

Reason: He believes in the possibility of change and brotherhood. (1 mark)

- a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

2.5 Choose the words that best describe the poet's attitude towards war. (1 mark)

- a) Acceptance and indifference
- b) Anger and condemnation
- c) Curiosity and fascination
- d) Pride and patriotism

3. **Extract 3:**

Perhaps the Earth can teach us as
when everything seems dead and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve and you keep quiet and I will go.

3.1 What can the Earth teach us? (1 mark)

- a) How to wage wars
- b) The cycle of life and death
- c) How to be inactive

d) The importance of speaking many languages

3.2 What does the poet do at the end of the poem? (1 mark)

a) Starts a war

b) Continues to speak

c) Counts up to twelve and leaves

d) Joins the fishermen

3.3 Assertion: The poet uses the Earth as a symbol of resilience.

Reason: The Earth shows that life can emerge from apparent stillness. (1 mark)

a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

3.4 Assertion: The poet concludes by asking everyone to remain quiet.

Reason: He believes that silence is essential for self-reflection. (1 mark)

a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

3.5 Choose the phrase that best conveys the central idea of these lines. (1 mark)

a) The power of nature

b) The futility of silence

c) The importance of activity

d) The destructiveness of war

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension

1.1 c) Observe complete silence

1.2 b) Persuasive

1.3 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

1.4 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

1.5 d) Unusual

2.1 c) Wars that destroy the environment

2.2 c) No survivors

2.3 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

2.4 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

2.5 b) Anger and condemnation

3.1 b) The cycle of life and death

3.2 c) Counts up to twelve and leaves

3.3 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

3.4 a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

3.5 a) The power of nature

Section B: Short Answer Questions (24 marks)

1. What does the poet mean by "without rush, without engines"? (2 marks)

2. Explain the significance of the line, "and the man gathering salt would look at his hurt hands." (2 marks)
3. If you were to apply the message of "Keeping Quiet" to social media, what changes would you suggest? (2 marks)
4. How can the concept of "keeping quiet" help in resolving personal conflicts? (2 marks)
5. The poem suggests that silence can be a powerful tool. Can you think of a real-life situation where silence was more effective than words? (2 marks)
6. What is the "sadness" that the poet refers to in the poem? (2 marks)
7. How does the poet use imagery to create a sense of stillness in the poem? (2 marks)
8. Explain the literary device used in the line "Life is what it is about; I want no truck with death." (2 marks)
9. Identify and explain the use of alliteration in the phrase "wars with gas, wars with fire." (2 marks)
10. Imagine you are a world leader. How would you use the message of the poem to promote peace? (2 marks)
11. Do you think the poem "Keeping Quiet" is relevant in today's fast-paced world? Justify your answer. (2 marks)
12. How does the poem "Keeping Quiet" promote the idea of universal brotherhood? (2 marks)

Section B: Short Answer Questions

1. "Without rush, without engines" signifies a world free from the chaos and noise of modern life, emphasizing a state of peace and tranquility.
2. This line highlights the suffering caused by human activity and suggests that in a moment of stillness, people might reflect on the consequences of their actions.
3. Applying "Keeping Quiet" to social media would mean promoting mindful engagement, reducing cyberbullying, and encouraging thoughtful communication over impulsive reactions.
4. "Keeping quiet" can help in resolving personal conflicts by allowing individuals to listen actively, understand different perspectives, and respond thoughtfully rather than react emotionally.
5. (Answers will vary. Example: A negotiation where silence was used strategically to make the other party reveal more information or reconsider their position.)
6. The "sadness" refers to the lack of self-understanding and the tendency of humans to threaten themselves with destruction and war.
7. The poet uses imagery like "without rush," "without engines," "a huge silence," and the stillness of the Earth to create a sense of quietude.
8. The literary device used is antithesis, contrasting "life" and "death" to emphasize the poet's preference for existence over destruction.
9. The use of alliteration in "wars with gas, wars with fire" emphasizes the harshness and intensity of destructive conflict through the repetition of the "w" sound.
10. (Answers will vary. Example: I would advocate for periods of silence and reflection in international dialogues to foster understanding and prevent hasty decisions that lead to conflict.)
11. Yes, the poem is highly relevant. In today's world of constant connectivity and noise, the message of introspection and peace is more important than ever for individual well-being and global harmony.

12. The poem promotes universal brotherhood by urging all of humanity to come together in a moment of silence, transcending linguistic and national barriers

Section C: Long Answer Questions (41 marks)

1. **Theme:** "Keeping Quiet" explores the theme of the need for introspection and its role in achieving peace. Discuss. (7 marks)
2. **Value:** How does the poem "Keeping Quiet" communicate the value of silence and stillness in a world obsessed with activity? (7 marks)
3. **Article:** Write an article for a national newspaper on "The Importance of Introspection in Modern Life," drawing insights from the poem "Keeping Quiet." (7 marks)
4. **Speech:** Prepare a short speech for your school assembly on "Finding Peace Within," inspired by the message of Pablo Neruda's "Keeping Quiet." (7 marks)
5. **Story:** Write a short story about a conflict between two friends and how they resolve it by "keeping quiet" and introspecting, as suggested by the poem. (6 marks)
6. **Author's Point of View:** Analyze Pablo Neruda's point of view in "Keeping Quiet." What message is he trying to convey to humanity? (7 marks)
7. **Diary Entry:** Write a diary entry expressing your reflections on the poem "Keeping Quiet" and how it has influenced your perspective on life. (6 marks)

Section C: Long Answer Questions (200 words each)

1. **Theme-based question:** "Keeping Quiet" explores the theme of the need for introspection and its role in achieving peace. Discuss.

Introduction: Pablo Neruda's poem "Keeping Quiet" delves into the profound theme of introspection as a crucial element for attaining peace, both individually and globally. The poem urges a cessation of worldly activities to facilitate a deeper understanding of oneself and others, ultimately advocating for a more harmonious existence.

Content Paragraph 1: Neruda emphasizes that much of the world's chaos and conflict stems from a lack of self-awareness. He suggests that by pausing our relentless pursuit of external goals and engaging in quiet contemplation, we can unravel the root causes of our destructive tendencies. This introspective journey allows us to confront our inner turmoil, recognize our shared humanity, and cultivate empathy.

Content Paragraph 2: The poem further posits that this individual introspection can translate into collective peace. By understanding ourselves, we become more capable of understanding and respecting others, fostering tolerance and breaking down the barriers that lead to conflict. Neruda's vision is not one of complete inactivity but rather a call for a balanced existence where inner reflection complements outward action, guiding it towards constructive ends.

Conclusion: In conclusion, "Keeping Quiet" powerfully conveys the idea that introspection is not a passive retreat from the world but an active process essential for achieving lasting peace. By looking inward, we can pave the way for a more compassionate and harmonious global community.

Value-based question: How does the poem "Keeping Quiet" communicate the value of silence and stillness in a world obsessed with activity?

Introduction: Pablo Neruda's "Keeping Quiet" presents a compelling case for the value of silence and stillness, contrasting it with the world's relentless obsession with activity. The poem argues that true connection and understanding are born from moments of quietude, offering a powerful critique of a society that often equates busyness with progress.

Content Paragraph 1: The poem suggests that the constant noise and rush of modern life prevent genuine communication and foster misunderstanding. By advocating for silence, Neruda isn't promoting inactivity but rather a shift in focus towards a different kind of action – the action of reflection, contemplation, and inner exploration. He believes that in stillness, we can hear our inner voice and truly listen to others.

Content Paragraph 2: Moreover, "Keeping Quiet" implies that stillness allows us to appreciate the interconnectedness of life. The image of the Earth that "seems dead and later proves to be alive" highlights the cyclical nature of existence and the importance of patience and observation. In a world that often prioritizes immediate results, the poem reminds us of the value of quiet observation and the wisdom that can be found in stillness.

Conclusion: Ultimately, Neruda's poem champions silence and stillness as essential tools for self-discovery, empathy, and a deeper understanding of the world. It challenges the notion that constant activity is the only path to progress, advocating for a more balanced and reflective way of being.

Article-based question: Write an article for a national newspaper on "The Importance of Introspection in Modern Life," drawing insights from the poem "Keeping Quiet."

Introduction: In today's frenetic world, where we are constantly bombarded with information and stimuli, the ability to introspect is becoming increasingly crucial yet elusive. Pablo Neruda's poem "Keeping Quiet" offers valuable insights into the significance of introspection for navigating the complexities of modern life.

Content Paragraph 1: Neruda's poem highlights that a lack of introspection can lead to a state of "sadness" – a feeling of being disconnected from ourselves and others. In a world that often prioritizes external achievements, introspection provides the space for self-awareness, allowing us to examine our values, motivations, and emotions. This self-knowledge is essential for making mindful decisions and living authentically.

Content Paragraph 2: Furthermore, introspection fosters empathy, a quality vital for harmonious relationships and social cohesion. By understanding our own inner experiences, we develop a greater capacity to understand and appreciate the perspectives of others. In a society often plagued by division and misunderstanding, the practice of introspection, as advocated by Neruda, can bridge gaps and cultivate compassion.

Conclusion: In conclusion, "Keeping Quiet" serves as a powerful reminder that introspection is not a luxury but a necessity in modern life. By embracing moments of stillness and self-reflection, we can cultivate personal well-being, strengthen our connections with others, and contribute to a more peaceful and understanding world.

Speech-based question: Prepare a short speech for your school assembly on "Finding Peace Within," inspired by the message of Pablo Neruda's "Keeping Quiet."

Introduction: Good morning, everyone. Today, I want to share some thoughts inspired by Pablo Neruda's beautiful poem "Keeping Quiet." This poem offers a simple yet profound message: the importance of finding peace within ourselves.

Content Paragraph 1: In our busy school lives, we're often caught up in a whirlwind of activities, studies, and social pressures. We rarely take a moment to pause, to breathe, and to

simply be still. Neruda's poem reminds us that this constant rush can lead to a sense of disconnection and unease. He urges us to "keep quiet," not just physically, but also mentally, to quiet the noise in our minds.

Content Paragraph 2: This stillness isn't about being inactive. It's about introspection – looking inward to understand our thoughts, feelings, and values. By practicing stillness, even for a few minutes each day, we can improve our concentration, reduce stress, and make more thoughtful choices. Finding peace within empowers us to navigate challenges with greater resilience and build stronger relationships with others.

Conclusion: So, let's take inspiration from "Keeping Quiet" and make a conscious effort to incorporate moments of stillness into our lives. Let's discover the strength and serenity that come from finding peace within. Thank you.

Story-based question: Write a short story about a conflict between two friends and how they resolve it by "keeping quiet" and introspecting, as suggested by the poem.

Introduction: Once upon a time, two inseparable friends, Alex and Ben, found their bond tested by a misunderstanding. A heated argument erupted, filled with accusations and hurt feelings, leaving a bitter silence between them.

Content Paragraph 1: In the days that followed, the silence grew heavier. Then, Alex remembered a poem he'd studied in class, "Keeping Quiet." Intrigued, he decided to put its message into practice. He stopped replaying the argument in his head and instead focused on quiet reflection. He tried to see the situation from Ben's perspective, acknowledging his own role in the conflict.

Content Paragraph 2: Unbeknownst to Alex, Ben was going through a similar process. He too had chosen to "keep quiet," not as a form of stubbornness, but as a way to introspect. He realized that his pride had fueled the argument and that their friendship was more valuable than being right.

Conclusion: When Alex and Ben finally met, the silence was no longer charged with anger but filled with understanding. They talked openly and honestly, each taking responsibility for their actions. By "keeping quiet" and introspecting, they had not only resolved their conflict but had also deepened their friendship.

Author's point of view-based question: Analyze Pablo Neruda's point of view in "Keeping Quiet." What message is he trying to convey to humanity?

Introduction: In "Keeping Quiet," Pablo Neruda adopts the perspective of a global citizen deeply concerned about humanity's self-destructive tendencies. His point of view is one of urgent yet hopeful appeal, urging a fundamental shift in our collective consciousness.

Content Paragraph 1: Neruda's central argument is that much of human suffering arises from a lack of introspection and self-understanding. He critiques our obsession with relentless activity and our engagement in conflict, suggesting that these behaviors stem from an inability to connect with our inner selves and empathize with others. He sees a need for a "huge silence" to interrupt this destructive cycle.

Content Paragraph 2: However, Neruda's point of view is not one of despair. He believes in humanity's potential for change and growth. The poem offers a message of hope, suggesting that by embracing stillness and introspection, we can cultivate peace, unity, and a more harmonious world. He envisions a world where people lay aside their "green wars" and walk together as "brothers".

Conclusion: Ultimately, Neruda's point of view in "Keeping Quiet" is that of a compassionate visionary. He calls for a transformation through quiet introspection, believing that it is the key to unlocking our shared humanity and building a more peaceful future.

Diary Entry-based question: Write a diary entry expressing your reflections on the poem "Keeping Quiet" and how it has influenced your perspective on life.

Introduction: Dear Diary, Today, I encountered a poem that has left me profoundly thoughtful – "Keeping Quiet" by Pablo Neruda. It has prompted me to reflect on my own life and the world around me in a new light.

Content Paragraph 1: Neruda's message about the power of silence and introspection struck a chord. I realized how often I rush through my days, caught up in the constant noise and activity, rarely giving myself time for quiet reflection. The poem made me question the value I place on busyness and the importance I give to my inner voice.

Content Paragraph 2: The idea that "a huge silence might interrupt this sadness / of never understanding ourselves" is particularly powerful. I see now that taking time to be still isn't a luxury but a necessity for self-discovery and peace. I'm inspired to incorporate moments of "keeping quiet" into my life, to listen more deeply to myself and others.

Conclusion: "Keeping Quiet" has shifted my perspective. I see now that true progress isn't just about doing more, but also about being more. I want to cultivate a more balanced life, one where action and stillness coexist, leading to greater understanding and peace.